



File No.: EXP202409902

RESOLUTION OF RIGHTS PROCEDURE

Having reviewed the complaint registered on June 25, 2024, with this Agency and having carried out the procedural actions provided for in Title VIII of Organic Law 3/2018, of December 5, on the Protection of Personal Data and the Guarantee of Digital Rights (hereinafter LOPDGDD), the following FACTS have been established:

FIRST: The complainant exercised the right of Erasure against the respondent, and their request, as stated by the complainant, did not receive the legally established response.

The complainant provides various documents related to the complaint filed with this Agency and regarding the exercise of the right exercised.

SECOND: Once the procedure established in Article 65.4 of the LOPDGDD was fulfilled, the complaint was admitted for processing, and the respondent entity was granted a hearing period, to present any arguments they deemed appropriate within ten working days.

With their written arguments, the respondent entity has submitted to this Agency the response to the exercised right. However, they do not provide documentation that proves that the request for the exercise of rights has been duly responded to the interested party.

LEGAL GROUNDS

I. Competence

In accordance with the powers granted to each supervisory authority by Article 58.2 of Regulation (EU) 2016/679 (General Data Protection Regulation, hereinafter GDPR), and as established in Articles 47, 48.1, and 64.1 of Organic Law 3/2018, of December 5, on the Protection of Personal Data and the Guarantee of Digital Rights (hereinafter, LOPDGDD), the Presidency of the Spanish Agency for Data Protection is competent to initiate and resolve this procedure.

Furthermore, Article 63.2 of the LOPDGDD states: "The procedures processed by the Spanish Agency for Data Protection shall be governed by the provisions of Regulation (EU) 2016/679, by this organic law, by the regulatory provisions issued for its development, and, in so far as they do not contradict them, subsidiarily by the general rules on administrative procedures."

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II. Preliminary Issues

In accordance with the provisions of Article 55 of the GDPR, the Spanish Agency for Data Protection is competent to perform the functions assigned to it in Article 57, including the enforcement of the Regulation and promoting awareness among controllers and processors regarding their obligations, as well as addressing complaints filed by an interested party and investigating, as appropriate, the reasons for them.

Correspondingly, Article 31 of the GDPR establishes the obligation of controllers and processors to cooperate with the supervisory authority that requests it in the performance of its functions. In cases where they have appointed a data protection officer, Article 39 of the GDPR assigns this officer the function of cooperating with that authority.

In accordance with this regulation, following the procedure established in Article 65.4 of the LOPDGDD, prior to the admission of the complaint regarding the exercise of the rights regulated in Articles 15 to 22 of the GDPR, which gives rise to this procedure, the complaint was forwarded to the respondent for analysis, to respond to this Agency within one month, and to prove that they had provided the complainant with the due response.

The result of this forwarding did not allow for the understanding that the complainant's claims had been satisfied. Consequently, on August 16, 2024, for the purposes provided for in Articles 64.1 and 65 of the LOPDGDD, the complaint was admitted for processing. This admission for processing determines

the opening of the present procedure for the lack of attention to a request for the exercise of the rights established in Articles 15 to 22 of the GDPR, regulated in Article 64.1 of the LOPDGDD, which states: "When the procedure refers exclusively to the lack of attention to a request for the exercise of the rights established in Articles 15 to 22 of Regulation (EU) 2016/679 of the European Parliament and of the Council, of April 27, 2016, it shall be initiated by an admission agreement, which shall be adopted in accordance with the provisions of Article 65 of this organic law.

In this case, the deadline for resolving the procedure shall be six months from the date on which the agreement of admission for processing was notified to the complainant. After that period, the interested party may consider their complaint upheld."

Article 58.2 of the GDPR grants the Spanish Agency for Data Protection a series of corrective powers to correct any infringement of the GDPR, including "ordering the controller or processor to address the requests for the exercise of the rights of the interested party under this Regulation."

III. Rights of Individuals in the Matter of Personal Data Protection

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The rights of individuals regarding the protection of personal data are regulated in Articles 15 to 22 of the GDPR and Articles 13 to 18 of the LOPDGDD. The rights of access, rectification, erasure, objection, the right to restriction of processing, and the right to data portability are contemplated.

The formal aspects related to the exercise of these rights are established in Articles 12 of the GDPR and 12 of the LOPDGDD.

Additionally, the provisions expressed in Recitals 59 and following of the GDPR are taken into account. In accordance with the provisions of these regulations, the data controller must establish formulas and mechanisms to facilitate the exercise of rights by the data subject, which shall be free of charge (without prejudice to the provisions of Articles 12.5 and 15.3 of the GDPR), and is obliged to respond to requests made no later than one month, unless it can demonstrate that it is unable to identify the data subject, and must express its reasons in case it does not intend to comply with such request. The burden of proof regarding compliance with the duty to respond to the request for the exercise of rights made by the affected party lies with the data controller.

The communication addressed to the data subject regarding their request must be expressed in a concise, transparent, intelligible, and easily accessible manner, using clear and simple language.

Regarding the right of access to personal data, according to the provisions of Article 13 of the LOPDGDD, when the exercise of the right refers to a large amount of data, the data controller may request the affected party to specify the "data or processing activities to which the request refers." The right shall be understood as granted if the data controller provides remote access to the data, considering the request as attended (although the data subject may request information regarding the aspects provided in Article 15 of the GDPR).

The exercise of this right may be considered repetitive more than once during a period of six months, unless there is a legitimate reason for it.

On the other hand, the request will be considered excessive when the affected party chooses a means other than the one offered that incurs a disproportionate cost, which must be borne by the affected party.

IV

Conclusion

In the analyzed case, the claimant exercised the right of Erasure regulated in Article 17 of the GDPR and Article 15 of the LOPDGDD.

After the period established in the aforementioned regulations, their request did not receive the legally required response.

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During the processing of this procedure, the entity being claimed has responded to this Agency, but does not prove to have attended to the request made by the claimant by sending the required response to their request.

In this regard, it should be noted that it cannot be accepted that the corresponding response may be expressed in the context of a mere administrative procedure, such as the submission of allegations regarding the present procedure, initiated precisely for not properly addressing the request in question. The aforementioned regulations do not allow for the request to be overlooked as if it had not been made, leaving it without the response that the data controllers are obliged to issue, even in cases where there are no data of the data subject in the entity's files or even in those cases where the requirements are not met, in which case the recipient of such request is also obliged to require the correction of the observed deficiencies or, if applicable, to deny the request with justification indicating the reasons why the right in question cannot be considered.

Therefore, the request made obliges the data controller to provide an express response, in any case, using any means that justifies the receipt of the response.

Since a copy of the necessary communication that must be directed to the claimant informing them about the decision made regarding the request for the exercise of rights is not attached, it is appropriate to uphold the claim that originated this procedure.

In view of the cited provisions and others of general application, the Presidency of the Spanish Agency for Data Protection RESOLVES:

FIRST: TO UPHOLD the claim made by A.A.A. considering that the provisions of Article 17 of the GDPR have been infringed and to urge the UNIVERSITY OF MURCIA, with NIF Q3018001B, to send to the claimant a certification within ten working days from the date this resolution becomes final and enforceable, addressing the right of Erasure exercised or denying it with justification indicating the reasons why the request cannot be attended to, in accordance with the provisions established in the body of this resolution. The actions taken as a consequence of this Resolution must be communicated to this Agency within the same period. Non-compliance with this resolution could result in the commission of an infringement of Article 83.6 of the GDPR, classified as very serious for the purposes of prescription in Article 72.1.m) of the LOPDGDD, which will be sanctioned, in accordance with Article 58.2 of the GDPR.

SECOND: NOTIFY this resolution to A.A.A. and to the UNIVERSITY OF MURCIA.

In accordance with the provisions of Article 50 of the LOPDGDD, this Resolution will be made public once it has been notified to the interested parties.

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Against this resolution, which concludes the administrative procedure (Article 18.4 of the LOPD), and in accordance with the provisions of Article 123 of Law 39/2015, of October 1, on the Common Administrative Procedure of Public Administrations, a voluntary appeal for reconsideration may be filed before the Director of the Presidency of the Spanish Agency for Data Protection, within one month from the day following the notification of this resolution, or directly an administrative contentious appeal before the Administrative Contentious Chamber of the National Court, in accordance with the provisions of Article 25 and Section 5 of the Fourth Additional Provision of Law 29/1998, of July 13, regulating the Administrative Contentious Jurisdiction, within two months from the day following the notification of this act, as provided in Article 46.1 of the aforementioned legal text.

1164-070324

Olga Pérez Sanjuán

The Deputy Director General of Data Inspection, in accordance with Art. 48.2 LOPDGDD, due to the

vacancy of the position of Presidency and Deputy
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